

■ VS CODE TERMINAL — COMPLETE SHORTCUTS & COMMANDS REFERENCE ■

Every shortcut to Open · Close · Kill · Switch · Split · Scroll · Edit · Navigate · Run your terminal

■ OPEN / CREATE TERMINAL

Shortcut / Command	What It Does
Ctrl + `	Open terminal panel (toggle)
Ctrl + Shift + `	Open a brand NEW terminal tab
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'New Terminal'	New terminal via palette
Terminal menu → New Terminal	From top menu bar
code .	Open VS Code + terminal in folder
Ctrl + Shift + 5	Split terminal (side by side)
Alt + Shift + D	Duplicate current terminal

■ CLOSE / KILL / END TERMINAL

Shortcut / Command	What It Does
Ctrl + C	STOP / KILL currently running command
Ctrl + D	Close current terminal session (EOF)
exit	Exit / close the terminal session
Ctrl + W	Close terminal tab (in some configs)
Trash icon (■)	Click trash icon in terminal panel
Kill Terminal button	Click X next to terminal name
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Kill Terminal'	Kill via command palette
Ctrl + Z then kill %1	Suspend then kill a background job

■ SWITCH / FOCUS / NAVIGATE TERMINALS

Shortcut / Command	What It Does
Alt + ← / Alt + →	Switch to previous / next terminal
Ctrl + PgUp	Go to previous terminal in list
Ctrl + PgDn	Go to next terminal in list
Ctrl + ` (toggle)	Focus terminal / focus editor
Ctrl + 1 / 2 / 3	Focus editor group 1 / 2 / 3
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Focus Terminal'	Focus via palette
Click terminal name	Switch to that terminal tab
Terminal dropdown (■)	Select terminal from dropdown list
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Move Terminal'	Move terminal to new panel

■ SPLIT / RESIZE TERMINAL

Shortcut / Command	What It Does
Ctrl + Shift + 5	Split terminal into two panes
Alt + Shift + D	Duplicate pane in split view
Ctrl + \	Split editor and terminal view
Drag terminal border	Resize terminal panel height
Ctrl + J	Toggle / hide terminal panel
Maximize icon (■)	Maximize terminal to full panel
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Resize'	Resize via command palette
Alt + Click pane	Focus a specific split pane

■ SCROLL TERMINAL		■ CLEAR TERMINAL SCREEN	
Shortcut / Command	What It Does	Shortcut / Command	What It Does
Shift + PgUp	Scroll terminal UP one page	Ctrl + L	Clear screen (keep history)
Shift + PgDn	Scroll terminal DOWN one page	cls	Clear screen — CMD only
		clear	Clear screen — PowerShell / bash
Ctrl + Shift + Up	Scroll UP one line	Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Clear'	Clear terminal via palette
Ctrl + Shift + Down	Scroll DOWN one line	Right-click → Clear	Clear via right-click menu
Mouse Scroll Wheel	Scroll up and down freely	reset	Full terminal reset
Ctrl + Home	Jump to very TOP of terminal	Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Scroll to Bottom'	Go to bottom of output
Ctrl + End	Jump to very BOTTOM of terminal		
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Scroll to Top'	Scroll top via palette		

—■ LINE EDITING SHORTCUTS (inside the terminal command line)		
Shortcut	Action	Category
Ctrl + A	Move cursor to BEGINNING of line	Navigation
Ctrl + E	Move cursor to END of line	Navigation
Ctrl + ← Arrow	Move cursor one WORD to the left	Navigation
Ctrl + → Arrow	Move cursor one WORD to the right	Navigation
Alt + B	Move BACK one word	Navigation
Alt + F	Move FORWARD one word	Navigation
Ctrl + U	Delete ENTIRE current line	Delete
Ctrl + K	Delete from cursor to END of line	Delete
Ctrl + W	Delete the PREVIOUS word	Delete
Alt + D	Delete the NEXT word	Delete
Ctrl + H	Delete one character backward (Backspace)	Delete
Ctrl + Y	PASTE last deleted text back	Paste
Ctrl + T	Swap current and previous character	Edit
Alt + U	Uppercase word from cursor	Edit
Alt + L	Lowercase word from cursor	Edit

■ COMMAND HISTORY		■ COPY / PASTE & SELECT	
Shortcut	What It Does	Shortcut	What It Does
↑ (Up Arrow)	Go to PREVIOUS command	Ctrl + C	Copy selected text
↓ (Down Arrow)	Go to NEXT command	Ctrl + V	Paste text into terminal
Ctrl + R	SEARCH through command history	Ctrl + Shift + C	Copy (alternative)
Ctrl + G	CANCEL history search	Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste (alternative)
Ctrl + P	Previous command (like Up arrow)	Right Click	Context menu — Copy / Paste
Ctrl + N	Next command (like Down arrow)	Ctrl + A (select all)	Select all terminal text
history	Show ALL past commands with numbers	Shift + Click	Select text range
!!	Repeat the LAST command	Double Click word	Select a single word
!n	Run command number n from history	Triple Click	Select entire line
!text	Run last command starting with text	Ctrl + Shift + K	Delete line in editor (not terminal)
history grep word	Search history for a word		

■ RUN / EXECUTE COMMANDS IN TERMINAL		
Shortcut / Command	Action	Works In
Enter	Execute / run the typed command	All
Ctrl + Alt + N	Run code file (Code Runner extension)	VS Code
Ctrl + Alt + M	Stop running code (Code Runner)	VS Code
F5	Start debugging / run with debugger	VS Code
Ctrl + F5	Run WITHOUT debugger	VS Code
Ctrl + Shift + B	Run build task	VS Code
gcc file.c -o out.exe && .\out.exe	Compile AND run in one line	CMD/PS
python file.py	Run Python file directly	All
node file.js	Run JavaScript file directly	All
Ctrl + C	STOP any currently running program	All
Ctrl + Z	PAUSE / suspend running process	All
bg	Resume paused job in BACKGROUND	Bash
fg	Bring background job to FOREGROUND	Bash

■■ TERMINAL PANEL & LAYOUT CONTROL	
Shortcut / Command	Action
Ctrl + J	TOGGLE terminal panel — show or hide it completely
Ctrl + `	Toggle terminal open / close
Ctrl + Shift + `	Open NEW terminal tab in panel
Ctrl + Shift + 5	SPLIT current terminal into two side-by-side panes
Ctrl + \	Split editor vertically alongside terminal
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'View: Toggle Panel'	Show/hide bottom panel via palette
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Terminal: Move to Editor Area'	Move terminal to editor area
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Terminal: Move to Panel'	Move terminal back to bottom panel
Drag panel divider	Resize the terminal panel height manually
Maximize button (■) in terminal	Expand terminal to fill full panel height
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Toggle Maximized Panel'	Maximize/minimize panel via palette

View → Appearance → Panel Position	Change panel to left/right/bottom
------------------------------------	-----------------------------------

■ CHANGE SHELL TYPE & PROFILE

Shortcut / Command	Action
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Terminal: Select Default Profile'	Set default shell (PowerShell / CMD / Git Bash)
Ctrl + Shift + P → 'Terminal: Create New Terminal (With Profile)'	Open terminal with specific shell
Terminal dropdown (■) → Select profile	Choose shell from dropdown arrow next to + button
Set-ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned	Allow PowerShell scripts to run (run as admin)
bash	Switch to Git Bash inside current terminal
powershell	Switch to PowerShell inside current terminal
cmd	Switch to CMD inside current terminal
wsl	Open Windows Subsystem for Linux terminal

■ QUICK REFERENCE CARD — MOST USED

OPEN NEW	CLOSE/KILL	SWITCH	CLEAR	SCROLL	RUN / STOP
Ctrl+Shift+`	Ctrl+C / exit	Alt+← / Alt+→	Ctrl+L / cls	Shift+PgUp/Dn	Enter / Ctrl+C

■ Tip: Ctrl+Shift+P opens the Command Palette — type any terminal action there if you forget the shortcut! | Ctrl+` is the fastest way to toggle your terminal on and off!